

# Khondoker Ittehadul Islam

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## Education

### University of Groningen, Saarland University

Groningen & Saarbrücken

DOUBLE DEGREE MASTER'S IN ERASMUS-MUNDUS NATURAL LANGUAGE PROCESSING

2024 - 2026 (Sept. expected)

- CGPA in German: 1.7/4.0 (Deep Learning Practicals: 1.0/4.0)
- Thesis: Analyzing Adaptation Methods on a Unified Framework.

### Shahjalal University of Science and Technology

Sylhet, Bangladesh

B.Sc. (ENGG.) IN COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

2017 - 2021

- CGPA: 3.35/4.00
- Thesis: Multi-lingual BERT in Low-resource Language Tasks.

## Professional Experience

2026 - now **Student Research Assistant**, MLT-Lab, DFKI

- Built a holistic safety-evaluation pipeline for foundation models across multiple modalities.
- Designed reproducible LLM-as-a-Judge, robustness, and prompt-injection benchmarks.
- *High-Level Findings Report* 📄

2024 - 2025 **Student Research Intern**, InCLow Lab, University of Groningen

- Analyzed LLM reasoning across languages, variants, and parameter scales.
- Utilized NLI, RAG, and attribution techniques in a cross-lingual evaluation.
- Publications: *BLP workshop @ IJCNLP-AAACL 2025* 📄.

2021 - 2024 **Software Engineer**, REVE Systems

- Digitalized the administrative workflow process of a Transport Organization.
- Incorporated Theory-of-Computation (ToC) concepts to automate the chain-of-decisions.
- Production: <https://smart.dgt.gov.bd/login> 📄

2020 - 2021 **Student Research Intern**, SUST NLP Research Group, Shahjalal University of Science & Technology

- Evaluated NN models on low-resourced Bangla language.
- Developed a high-sparsity corpus and an annotation-quality metric.
- Reported mBERT's critical performance on two downstream tasks.
- Publications: *Findings of EMNLP 2021* 📄, *AAACL-IJCNLP 2022* 📄

## Selected Research Projects

### Tackling OOV: Masked Language Models vs Character Diffusion

2026

Saarland University

Saarbrücken, Germany

- Trained NanoGPT and Character Diffusion on Spell-Corrected Corpus.
- Reported higher Character Diffusion performance on the OLID task.
- Repo: <https://github.com/KhondokerIslam/mlm-vs-dlm-on-oov> 📄

### Evaluating Protein Language Models in Long Protein Sequence Generation

2026

Saarland University

Saarbrücken, Germany

- Evaluated state-of-the-art PLM on >1k long-sequence generation tasks.
- Observed random baselines to perform better.
- Repo: <https://github.com/KhondokerIslam/ml4lp> 📄

### Attributing Multilingual LLM CoT Reasoning Answers

2025

University of Groningen

Groningen, Netherlands

- Attributed step-level reasoning in Qwen2.5-1.5B's CoT outputs.
- Identified excessive attribution score on the final reasoning step.
- Received *Best NLP Student Project Award*.
- Report: <https://arxiv.org/pdf/2511.15886> 📄

## OCR on Historical Documents

University of Groningen

2025

Groningen, Netherlands

- Improved linguistic capabilities of vLMs for OCR tasks.
- Composited image to augment ancient documents.
- Heuristically pseudo-labeled multi-class unlabeled documents.
- *Report*: <https://arxiv.org/pdf/2508.10356> 

## Fallacy Detection On Presidential Speech

University of Groningen

2025

Groningen, Netherlands

- Leveraged emotional cues in debate speeches.
- Mapped paralinguistic features into text to enhance reasoning.
- *Report*: <https://arxiv.org/pdf/2509.11127> 

## Offensive Text Classification Leveraging Sentiment

University of Groningen

2024

Groningen, Netherlands

- Collected sentiment for each OLID instances using DeBERTa V3.
- Observed no positive-sentiment effect on offensive classification.
- *Report*: <https://arxiv.org/pdf/2412.17825> 

## Affect of Transfer Learning on Noisy Bangla Text

Shahjalal University of Science & Technology

2020

Sylhet, Bangladesh

- Evaluated knowledge transfer of diverse NN models.
- Reported BERT's competitive performance.
- *Publication*: ICCIT 2020 

## Publications

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- **Khondoker Ittehadul Islam**, Gabriele Sarti; Reveal-Bangla: A Dataset for Cross-Lingual Multi-Step Reasoning Evaluation. **BLP workshop @ IJCNLP-AAACL 2025**. 
- **Khondoker Ittehadul Islam**, Tanvir Hossain Yuvraz, Md Saiful Islam, Enamul Hassan; EmoNoBa: A Dataset for Analyzing Fine-Grained Emotions on Noisy Bangla Texts. **AAACL-IJCNLP 2022**. 
- **Khondoker Ittehadul Islam**, Sudipta Kar, Md Saiful Islam, Mohammad Ruhul Amin; SentNoB: A Dataset for Analysing Sentiment on Noisy Bangla Texts. **Findings of EMNLP 2021**. 
- **Khondoker Ittehadul Islam**, Md Saiful Islam, and Md Ruhul Amin; Sentiment analysis in Bengali via transfer learning using multi-lingual BERT. **ICCIT 2020**. 

## Skills

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**Programming & Tools** Python, Git, Docker, Slurm, Bash, Weights & Biases, LaTeX

**LLM & ML Frameworks** PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, vLLM, NumPy, Pandas

**Research Areas** Evaluation Pipelines, LLM-as-a-Judge, Interpretability, AI Safety, Red Teaming

## Awards

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- 2025 **Best NLP Student Project Award**, @GroNLP, University of Groningen  
*Competed with 6 other student teams to produce impactful research.*
- 2025 **Google & Zendesk Scholarship**, LxMLS 2025  
*Received expenses to participate in Lisbon ML Summer School.*
- 2025 **Erasmus+ Scholarship**, Erasmus Mundus  
*Received stipendium to assist my research traineeship.*
- 2024 **NL Scholarship**, Nuffic, Dutch Ministry of Education, Culture, and Science  
*Awarded stipendium to support my academic endeavors.*
- 2023 **Outstanding Reviewer**, BLP Workshop @ EMNLP 2023  
*Assisted program chairs and authors through constructive feedback.*
- 2021 **Student Travel Scholarship**, EMNLP 2021  
*Received financial coverage to present my proceedings paper.*